

Ministry of Forests, Lands and Natural Resource Operations

BC River Forecast Centre

High Streamflow Advisory: South Interior

Updated: 14 May 2013 9:35 AM

The BC River Forecast Centre is **downgrading** the advisory to a **High Streamflow Advisory** for:

- Granby River
- Kootenay Region (medium-sized watersheds including the Slocan River, Moyie River, Salmo River, Elk River, Bull River)
- Osoyoos Lake – **ADDED**

The BC River Forecast Centre is **ending** a **High Streamflow Advisory** for:

- Mission Creek
- Similkameen (including the Tulameen River, the mainstem of the Similkameen, and tributaries)
- Boundary (West Kettle and Kettle Rivers and small tributary creeks)
- Kootenay Region (small-sized watersheds including Redfish Creek and Duhamel Creek)

Temperatures have dropped significantly over the past day, and this has led to reduced snow melt rates throughout the South Interior. The Kootenay region received moderate precipitation yesterday (5 - 30mm of rain was observed at automated snow pillows), with 5 - 10mm of rain observed through the Okanagan.

A summary of current conditions:

- Granby River near Grand Forks (08NN002) gauge is currently not reporting. The river is expected to have stabilized but remain high. Levels are expected to drop through today and into the rest of the week.
- West Kettle River at Westbridge (08NN003) and the Kettle River near Westbridge (08NN026) are both below a 2-year flow and river levels are dropping.
- Mission Creek near East Kelowna (08NM116) is currently at 47 m³/s (below a 2-year flow) and river levels are dropping.
- Elk River at Fernie (08NK002) is currently at 270 m³/s (between a 2-year and 5-year flow) and is expected to see continued modest rise through today.

A **High Streamflow Advisory** means that river levels are rising or expected to rise rapidly, but that no major flooding is expected. Minor flooding in low-lying areas is possible.

A **Flood Watch** means that river levels are rising and will approach or may exceed bankfull. Flooding of areas adjacent to affected rivers may occur.

A **Flood Warning** means that river levels have exceeded bankfull or will exceed bankfull imminently, and that flooding of areas adjacent to the rivers affected will result.

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With cooling temperatures and low rainfall amounts forecasted over the coming days, river levels are expected to improve tomorrow and through the week.

On Osoyoos Lake, high flow rates from the Similkameen River are causing a back-water effect at the lake outlet, and affecting the outflow rates from the lake. Lake levels are expected to continue to rise over the next few days.

The River Forecast Centre will continue to monitor conditions and will provide updates as conditions warrant.

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